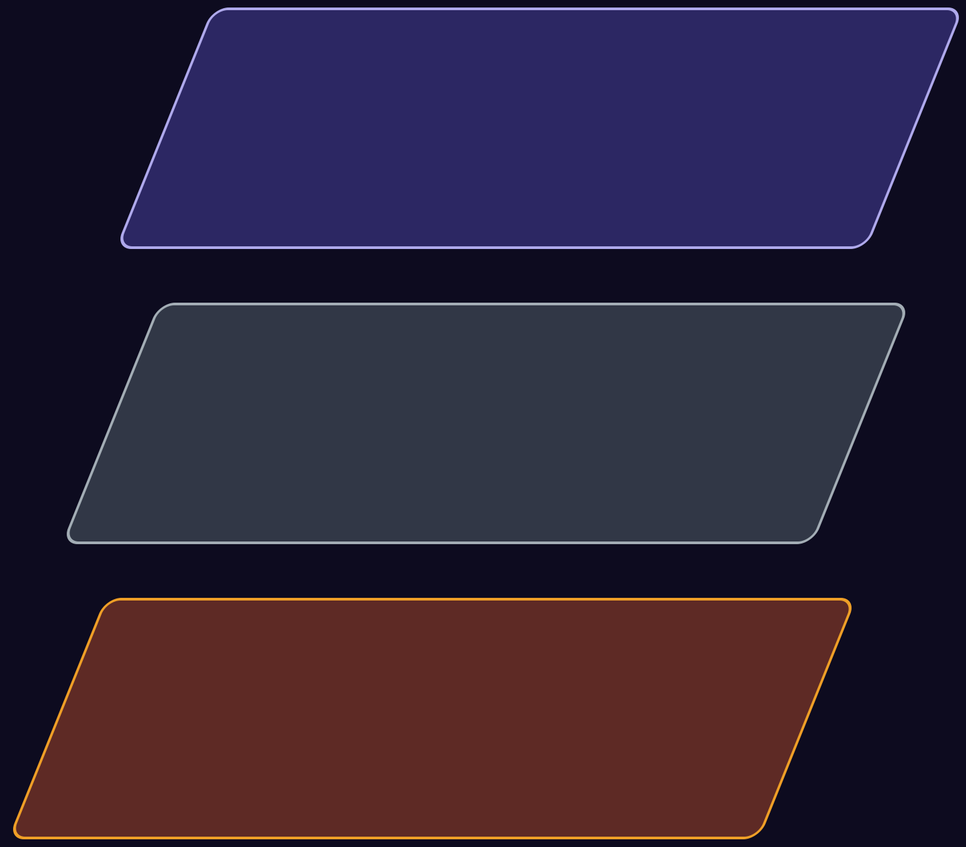
GAME PITCH · WORKING TITLE

# Plane Shift

A 2D puzzle-platformer where moving forward or backward feels like entering another dimension.

Project 5 · AET 330T AI Explorations, Fall 2026



# Seven ideas explored, one chosen

CHOSEN

## Plane Shift

A clear, testable core mechanic with fixed rules, already specified, and scoped to finish in five weeks.

### Rifter

Tear rifts between dimensions to free a 2D prisoner. Evolved into Plane Shift.

### Wizarding Runes

Draw runes in the air to cast spells.

### Speed Horror

Sprint through a generated forest with a pursuer on your heels.

### Echo

Sound pulses reveal a dark world.

### Ghost Loop

Cooperate with replays of your past runs.

### Fold

Fold a 2D world to join distant platforms.

THE CORE QUESTION

# Where is there open space in a world I can’t fully see?

A stack of 2D planes shares one set of coordinates. You live in one plane at a time and shift to a neighbor, keeping your momentum. When a wall blocks you, find the plane where that same spot is open.

**3**
planes, one shared space

**1**
real plane at a time

**3**
rule sets, fixed for the whole game

# Three planes, three rule sets



## W Background

Low gravity: floaty, high jumps

Many enemies, few hazards · violet



## Midground HOME PLANE

Normal gravity: the baseline

A prison maze, balanced enemies and hazards · slate



## S Foreground

Heavy: short jumps, breaks weak floors

Many hazards, few enemies · ember

GAMEPLAY MOCKUP

# Cell block C · Room 04

Dashed ghosts show where a shift would land: violet behind, ember in front.



# How shifting works

## Momentum carries

Position and speed stay with you. Vertical speed adapts to the new plane’s gravity.

## Blocked shifts

If the spot is solid, the camera shakes and returns. You stay where you were.

## One shift per airtime

Shift once while airborne. Landing refreshes it. Shifting on the ground is unlimited.

## Carried objects shift too

Crates and keys follow the new plane’s rules. Carry a crate into Heavy to break a weak floor.

A D Move  Space Jump  W Shift back  S Shift forward

# Who it is for, and how it should feel

PLAYERS

## Puzzle-platformer fans

Players of Fez, Portal and Limbo, in short sessions on a Windows PC.

- See where a shift is possible
- Rules that stay the same
- Failure that is cheap

NOTICE

Three distinct planes: cool behind, warm in front.

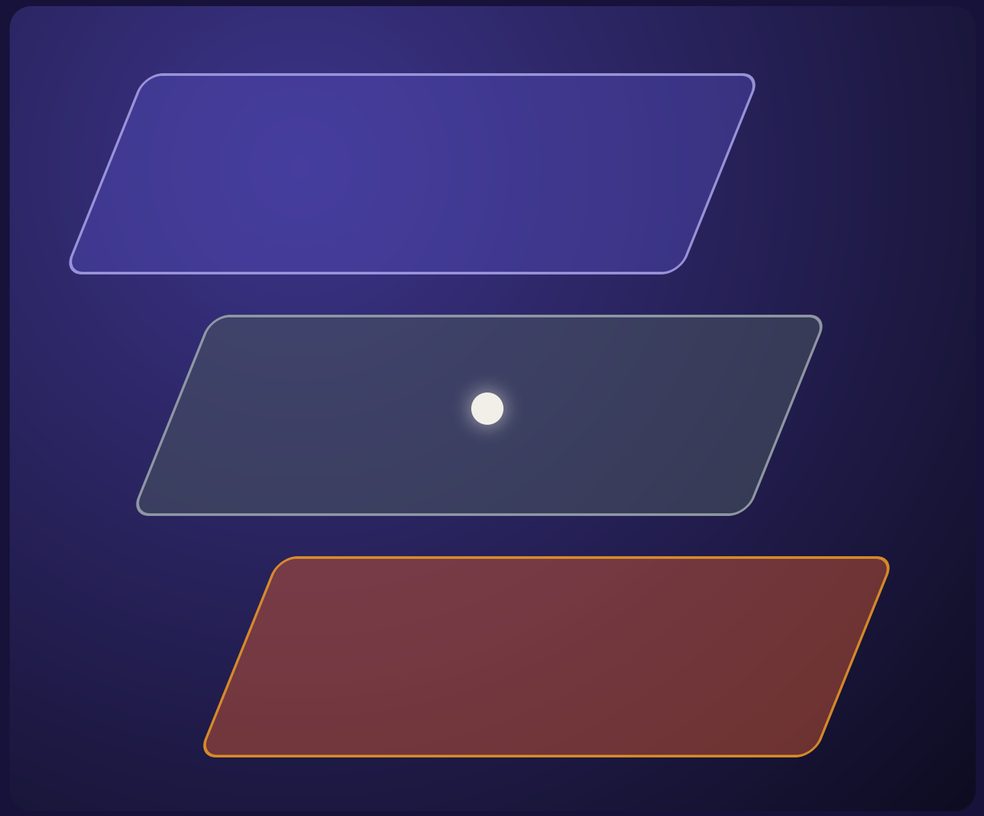
FEEL

Floaty, normal and heavy movement, and the click of finding open space.

BE ABLE TO

Shift planes, shift mid-air to carry momentum across, and solve the opening rooms.

# Glassy, futuristic, minimalist



Clean shapes, translucent planes you can see through, and simple glow. Temperature tells depth: cool behind, warm in front.

| | |
|---|---|
| **Violet** | Background |
| **Slate** | Midground |
| **Ember** | Foreground |
| **Near-white** | The player, on every plane |

# What the system does, and what it runs on

### Plane stack
Only the current plane is solid; neighbors are visible but untouchable.

### Per-plane rules
Fixed gravity and movement values, with momentum adapting on entry.

### Shift logic
Blocked shifts, one shift per airtime, carried objects.

### Readability
Parallax per plane, landing ghosts and a player silhouette.

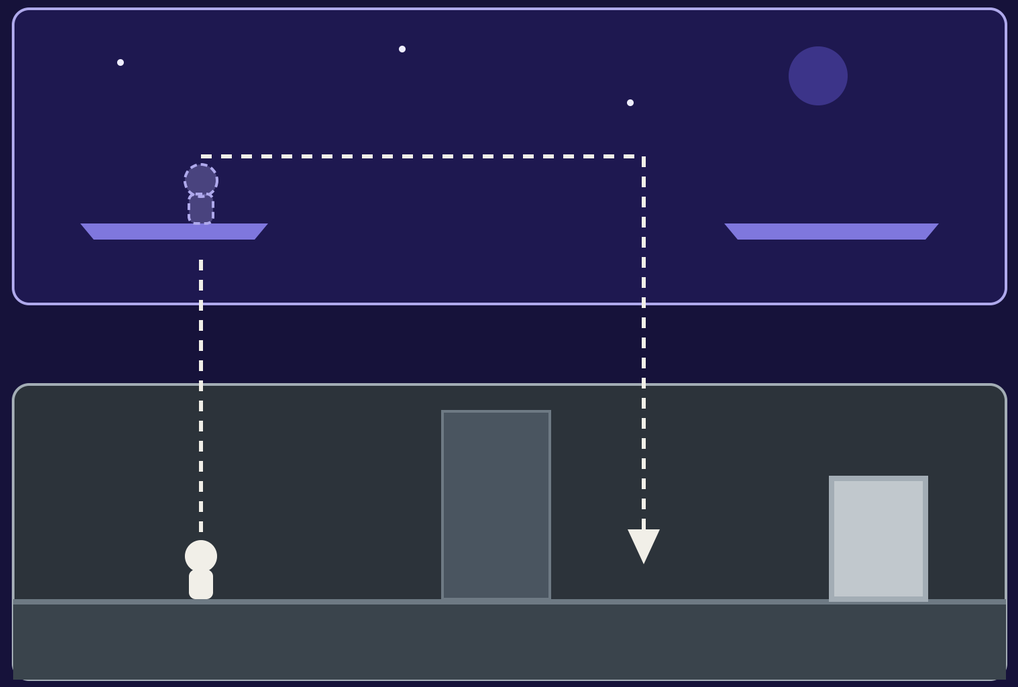
STACK · BUILT FROM SCRATCH

Unity | URP 2D Renderer | C# | Shader Graph | Input System | Git + GitHub | Windows build

No new technologies to learn. Version to be pinned at project setup.

**The challenge I am taking on:** make a three-plane stack readable at 60 FPS, with rules simple enough to learn one at a time.

# The MVP: one room, two planes



1. Move and jump with A, D and Space.
2. Press W to shift to the background.
3. The wall blocks the midground; the background is open.
4. Cross it, shift back, reach the exit.

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IT WORKS WHEN

- ✓ A new tester completes the room
- ✓ A shift into a solid triggers the blocked response
- ✓ It runs at 60 FPS

# Five weeks to a playable build

PHASE 1

**Oct 26–Nov 2**

Ideas, choice and pitch.

PHASE 2

**Nov 2–9**

Prove the core: the MVP room, shift, blocked shift, parallax.

PHASE 3

**Nov 9–16**

Foreground plane, momentum rules, rooms 1–4.

PHASE 4

**Nov 16–30**

Carrying, hazards, enemies, rooms 5–7, menus, audio.

PHASE 5

**Nov 30–Dec 7**

Peer-review fixes, juice, final build.

**Nov 9** milestone check

**Nov 30** peer review

**Dec 7** public Windows build

# Risks and stretch goals

## RISKS, AND HOW I WILL FIND OUT EARLY

**Readability across three planes**
Test the MVP room with a new player in Phase 2

**Parallax and ghosts feel wrong**
Tune in the prototype

**Momentum rules feel unfair**
Playtest air shifts in Phase 3

**Too many rooms to build**
Count rooms at the end of Phase 3, cut from the end

**Plane themes undecided**
Decide by Nov 9

## STRETCH GOALS, IN ORDER

1. Hold-to-peek
2. Slingshot throw
3. Juice pass
4. Self-shifting objects and enemies
5. Optional collectibles

**Decision requested:** approve Plane Shift to begin Phase 2 on Nov 2.